

GETTING DOWN TO BRASS TACKS Union minister Ashwini Vaishnaw with India Today Group Editorial Director Raj Chengappa and Deputy Editor Anilesh S. Mahajan

Photographs by CHANDRADEEP KUMAR, RAJWANT RAWAT

"The country had to wait six years for a PM like Modiji to start focusing on the core safety of railways"

"We started (5G rollout) in 2022, but we already have surpassed almost all the big economies. Already, we have crossed about 380,000 base stations"

"I can promise you, within the next 12 months, you'll see many more (semiconductor) units coming to the country"

ASHWINI VAISHNAW Union Minister for Railways, Communications, Electronics & Information Technology

shift of cargo from road to rail...better passenger experience... about a thousand stations already constructed according to world-class standards.

BEING SAFE WITH KAVACH

The entire world moved to these (automatic train protection) systems in the 1990s. Now, when did India start on this journey? 2016... what was the Congress doing all these years?

PRIVATISATION OF RAILWAYS

I've told it on the floor of Parliament: we are not privatising railways... We are very clear about it. Railways is a very, very complex system. It's not a system that anybody can understand in a few years.

5G CATCHING SPEED

We have jumped about 78 positions in the global test. On network satisfaction, we have now 32 per cent increase in network satisfaction.

'DUOPOLY' IN TELECOM?

We have done everything that was possible to do... We have made sure that the industry comes out of its legacy issues of series of litigations... it is now healthy.... Close to Rs 1.5 lakh crore investment has happened. India's telecom sector is being viewed as a sunrise sector. And we'll see good competition, good technology and good quality of service.

REVIVING BSNL

Today, BSNL has a very healthy balance sheet.... In the coming 12 months, you'll see BSNL as a healthy company, which has a significantly stabilising influence on the market.

MAKING IN INDIA

We have just approved and announced that 27 companies will be manufacturing laptops, tablets and servers, many of them designed in India. ■